

Setup Guide

Use OrcaRouter with Codex and Claude Code

What you need

An OrcaRouter account, an API key, and Codex or Claude Code installed.

What you will configure

OrcaRouter as the API gateway for your coding client.

Important note

Free usage is subject to the account offer and quota.

The OrcaRouter dashboard shown in your screenshots says Codex requests need spendable balance or claimed free calls. Creating an API key alone does not guarantee unlimited free requests. Check the dashboard for the current free allowance, rate limits, and any required activation before making your first request.

Part 1 - Create your OrcaRouter API key

1 Open OrcaRouter and sign in

Open the OrcaRouter website and sign in to your account.

2 Create an API key

Choose Get Your API Key and create a new API key. Copy the key somewhere secure.

Security reminder

Treat your API key like a password. Do not paste it into public code, GitHub, screenshots, or chat messages.

Part 2 - Set up Codex

3 Open the Codex configuration file

Create or edit the file below:

```
~/.codex/config.toml
```

4

Add the OrcaRouter provider configuration

Paste the following configuration into `~/.codex/config.toml`:

```
model = "orcarouter/auto"
model_provider = "orcarouter"

[model_providers.orcarouter]
name = "OrcaRouter"
base_url = "https://api.orcarouter.ai/v1"
wire_api = "responses"
env_key = "ORCA_KEY"
```

Codex - add your API key

Set the `ORCA_KEY` environment variable to the API key you created in OrcaRouter.

macOS

```
launchctl setenv ORCA_KEY "YOUR_ORCAROUTER_API_KEY"
```

Linux

```
echo 'export ORCA_KEY="YOUR_ORCAROUTER_API_KEY"' >> ~/.profile
```

Restart Codex / your editor

Fully quit and reopen your editor after setting the key. The OrcaRouter dashboard notes that an ordinary shell export may not reach an editor launched from the Dock or Start menu.

5

Start Codex

Launch Codex normally. The configuration above routes requests through OrcaRouter using `orcarouter/auto`.

Part 3 - Set up Claude Code

Claude Code can use OrcaRouter through its Anthropic-compatible API endpoint.

6

Use the Anthropic-compatible endpoint

The dashboard shown in your screenshots lists this base URL for Anthropic-protocol tools:

```
https://api.orcarouter.ai
```

Anthropic-compatible clients append the versioned messages path themselves.

7

Add your OrcaRouter API key

Configure Claude Code to use the OrcaRouter key as its API credential, following the credential/environment-variable method supported by your Claude Code installation.

8

Start Claude Code

Restart Claude Code after setting the credential and verify that requests are reaching OrcaRouter.

Useful endpoints

Client	Endpoint	Use
Codex / OpenAI-compatible	https://api.orcarouter.ai/v1	OpenAI-compatible API base URL
Claude Code / Anthropic-compatible	https://api.orcarouter.ai	Anthropic protocol base URL

Troubleshooting

Quota / balance error	Check the OrcaRouter dashboard and make sure you have a spendable balance or an active free-call allocation.
Codex cannot see the key	Fully restart the editor/Codex. On macOS, use the launchctl command shown above; on Linux, log out/in or otherwise refresh the environment after updating ~/.profile.
Requests use the wrong model	Keep model = "orcarouter/auto" for automatic routing, or select a model supported by your OrcaRouter account/catalog if your client exposes model selection.

Quick checklist

- ✓ Create OrcaRouter account
- ✓ Create and copy API key
- ✓ Configure Codex or Claude Code
- ✓ Set ORCA_KEY / supported credential
- ✓ Restart the client
- ✓ Check free-call/quota status before first request

Note: Product names and endpoints can change. Re-check the OrcaRouter dashboard and documentation for the latest integration instructions before publishing or deploying.